

Pulse

CariSurg MedTech Pathways — Week 0, Day 4 Write-up

Pulse measures how many times the heart beats per minute (bpm), felt as a throbbing sensation at the wrist or neck as blood is pushed through the arteries. In healthy adults, a normal resting pulse falls between 60 and 100 bpm, and can rise with exercise, illness, injury, or emotional stress. Readings below 60 bpm are called bradycardia and above 100 bpm tachycardia — both can point to underlying cardiovascular or physiological problems. For a triage nurse, pulse is one of the fastest and most informative checks available: a weak, racing pulse may indicate shock or severe blood loss, while an unexpectedly slow one can signal a heart rhythm problem or drug toxicity, either of which demands immediate clinical attention.

Reference

Johns Hopkins Medicine. (2025). *Vital signs (body temperature, pulse rate, respiration rate, blood pressure)*. <https://www.hopkinsmedicine.org/health/conditions-and-diseases/vital-signs-body-temperature-pulse-rate-respiration-rate-blood-pressure>